

THE ERA OF THE NEW AGE AND NEW CONSCIOUSNESS

Blessings and love and greetings to all of you, my dearest ones. With immense joy do we resume our contact for this coming working period. The rejoicing in our world is great. This rejoicing can communicate itself to you if you open yourself to feeling it. The rejoicing has to do with what has been accomplished with many of you individually and as a whole. But the rejoicing is also about what is to come. For more of what you have experienced in growth and liberation, in peace and joyousness will come this year for those of you who really devote yourselves to your own innermost path.

Now, my dearest friends, you have heard from me and from many other sources again and again that an immense new cosmic force that will sweep this earth planet has been released into the universe. Its forerunners have made themselves known already for a number of years. These forerunners have various aspects, and I do not need to go into the details. Suffice it to say that a new surge toward spiritual truth is spreading over your world. New values seek to push through old resistances. I will speak in this lecture about the meaning of this new cosmic force in terms of your community and in terms of your individuality and your growth -- where it leads and what it means.

Many times in the past I have spoken about the "entity earth" -- the planet earth that is an entity of which each individual inhabiting it is a cell, just as your own entity consists of so many cells. Each of these cells is a consciousness and an energy center, as you are a consciousness and an energy center. Now the entity earth is growing up. It is coming within itself to an inner crossroads in a similar way as the growing individual who comes to an inner crossroads. You have all experienced at one time or another on your path that one part of you is ready to expand, to open up, to risk new modalities through exposure of its hidden secrets, to move toward a new and entirely expanded vision of life, of self, and of a new modality of being. The new modality does not shed the old but, rather, transforms of the old what is not compatible with the new, pure, and great influx, and incorporates the pure substance of the old self into the new expanded version of it.

You also know that, at the same time, the other part of you that we call the lower self obstructs this movement. It is fearful and distrustful of it and resists it. Which part you ally yourself with depends on your ego consciousness. In such a struggle and conflict, crisis is inevitable. The resisting part creates the crisis by obstructing the inexorable, unhaltable movement of the evolutionary force. The less this struggle is recognized for what it is, the more its real significance is denied and rationalized, the greater an upheaval it must cause, and the more frightening this upheaval will appear in its possible temporary physical manifestation. Conversely, the more this struggle is recognized for what it really is and the more the personality acts in accordance with the higher self principles, the shorter the crisis will be, and, in fact, that same crisis will transform itself into undreamed-of bliss.

So you see that crisis is healthy and unavoidable, as I have also explained in the past. Growth cannot exist without crisis. For to the extent that growth is being resisted, crisis exists. The lower self is not merely devious, dishonest, selfish; the lower self is also ignorant. It chooses to remain in its ignorance, and this ignorance makes it stubborn, unperceptive, as well as destructive and negative in various ways.

The entity earth also possesses a lower self. That lower self, as with the individual, is not only negative, selfish, greedy, dishonest; it is also ignorant "with a vengeance." It totally resists the process of the new influx the soul is ready for. Thus there is crisis on this earth. You see the crisis as much as you see here and there expansion of new ways of being, new understanding, deeper vision of life, and deeper perception of spiritual reality. These new expansions are not always without their distortions and exaggerations, without their fanaticism and misunderstandings, without their using the sense of the great new influx as an escape from meeting and dealing with the unpurified matter in the soul. Such abuse will turn out to be particularly costly and disappointing to the individual. There are many attempts of this force to come through, but not in all quarters is the total responsibility and meaning of it thoroughly understood and lived by. So there are many spiritual movements which seek to follow the pressure from within, without giving themselves to the necessary work that needs to be done within the soul. The spirit world has been preparing for this new expansion for many decades and centuries. It has been preparing intensely, with a great deal of investment and energy. Many are called but not all follow, although some may think that they do. Not all are sufficiently willing to give themselves to the inner call. If this is clearly acknowledged, it is better, for at least the possibility exists for later following this call. If, however, it is explained away and illusions and delusions are accepted as if they were really valid reasons for the decision, then the soul is in confusion.

Now the entity earth is going through such a struggle. There are those who resist the movement and the depth and the light of the new consciousness. They have a stake in making themselves deaf and blind to it. Many of them would possess the mental and spiritual equipment to follow the movement, but choose out of pride, fear, and self-will not to follow, not even to notice it. There are others, of course, who are not yet ready in their spiritual development to even know that levels of reality exist that cannot be seen with the physical eye. And then, of course, there are those who do follow the influx and the force of the movement, often at first not even quite understanding what is at stake.

Those who follow it will find the deepest joy and blessings and need not fear anything. They only need to rejoice. In following the influx, they keep in harmony with the universe. They are within the process, rather than obstructing it. They are also needed as physical channels for the further penetration of the Christ consciousness into the new era. Their ever renewed decision to give all of themselves to the process that has encompassed them will make their life as fulfilled and glorious as it will be useful and meaningful to the whole of evolution.

My dearest friends, the fulfillment of this surge cannot occur unless the most profound purification process takes place. With this particular community, the emphasis on the personal purification has existed, as you very well know, for all these years. Until now, this emphasis was directed exclusively toward your individual fulfillment. Now a new phase has arisen where your own inner expansion has readied you to realize that individual fulfillment is the necessary basis for fulfilling a task in cohesiveness with the total movement that sweeps your world. In other words,

more is and must be at stake than your individual fulfillment. When I say more, it may sound as though your individual fulfillment is not important, and that may indeed appear to be a contradiction to what I just said before. I always emphasize the importance of your individual happiness, wholeness, and freedom from obstruction. It is not a contradiction. Your individual fulfillment, which cannot exist to the extent you are unpurified and alienated from the truth of your inner processes, is the most important thing, and at the same time there is something much more at stake. Perhaps I can put it in the following way: you can only find total individual fulfillment if you serve a greater cause. Many of you in this work almost inadvertently found this to be so. The guidance of events has brought you to realize -- some more consciously, some more intuitively -- that there is a great task involved and that you are involved in simultaneously serving that while you fulfill yourself. You have found that this very service enhances your fulfillment, just as this service requires you to be a fulfilled and happy person. You are beginning to experience that fulfillment of the self lies in the service. And the service can only be executed through self-fulfillment. In other words, the three-dimensional apparent contradiction and dichotomy must prove, once again, to be faulty perception. Oneness exists in what appear as opposites. The individual is only apparently opposed to the whole.

In this coming working year we will deal with your expanded consciousness that will learn in a more deliberate way, in a more conscious way to perceive the importance of service to the whole Christ consciousness that is infiltrating your universe. This will change life, consciousness, and values in a very drastic way for those who are willing to follow that dynamic movement. In the lectures I will give to you I will increasingly concentrate on this aspect so as to help open up a new vista for you so that you comprehend exactly the difference between the old values and the new values, the old consciousness and the new consciousness; so that you view your own personal fulfillment as exactly what it is: a necessary tool with which you can serve. For the unhappy and frustrated person cannot serve, cannot put himself to the task of enriching life, enriching others, and setting a desirable example. For how can the poor enrich? That is not possible. Neither is it possible to pretend. For the followers know in a much deeper place in themselves, an inner place that really counts, whether those who lead pretend or are real in their own state of fulfillment.

Only the person who is fully centered in his own God consciousness and is thus able to create his life according to his needs and wishes can enliven his surroundings and teach it, be it through actual teaching in one form or another or be it by the mere example of his life, by his joyousness, his love, his capacity to be the best he is and thus fulfill a task in the great venture. For many different tasks are needed, but all who serve in this cause must be examples and leaders representing the new consciousness and the new values in their own lives.

Now, my friends, I would like to explain to you another dichotomy you have experienced in the course of this work. Most of you, who are starting this work, have a compulsion to be good, like many other human beings. You may fear your selfishness. But your mask has put a cloak over the selfishness and the little meannesses. That mask makes you comply with higher standards so as to appear to be a very good person. Often the real surge and message from the higher self is interwoven and mixed up with this masking cloak, this false goodness in appearance. In your pathwork many of you have already extensively dealt with that aspect in you where you sell out your genuine self-interest, your real rights in order to please some imaginary authority. You have also found that you have done so not out of a pure spirit of service but because you had your designs. You always wanted this authority to do something for you that was not honest to expect and that

you really would have to shoulder yourself in order to become fully yourself. You work through these aspects again and again and again until you find the strength to relinquish the secret hope, to cease the false service, to become more self-responsible and consequently also more self-assertive. You find these two in equal balance. The more you stop cheating in these secret ways that you pretend do not exist, the more you therefore stop the false goodness, the more you assert your right to have the best in life. The guilt ceases because you live honestly. When dependence and the thus resulting submission and lack of selfhood exist, to speak of service to a greater cause would be premature because you would then misuse it and perpetuate the pretenses of the mask self, and the service would be put into the wrong channel. So you had to learn to be selfish, my friends.

As you know, there is a right kind of selfishness and there is a wrong kind of selfishness. The right kind of selfishness preserves the right to unfold in the best way for you regardless of the opinions of others and their possibly covert reasons to exploit you. This kind of selfishness can recognize and refute easily other people's exploitative demands rather than submitting to them because of your own. A person with the right kind of selfishness feels deeply deserving to acquire happiness because he will never want it at the expense of others. It is a distorted, wrong kind of selfishness which splits the interest of self and others. In the right kind, these interests must be one.

It is at first a complicated procedure to sort out the misunderstandings. But once you have accomplished this along the spiral movement of your path, there is no longer a dichotomy between the self and others. Self and others are one. When you free yourself of the real guilt of your hiding and of your pretenses, of disguising the hidden agenda and perpetuated negativity, then you will not feel unworthy of becoming the best, the happiest and most fulfilled person. Then service is not a substitute and compensation for guilt.

On this path we want to prepare as many human beings as possible for the great event that sweeps your universe. This requires strong and guilt-free souls who do what they do for the real reasons, not for false ones. So your path had to first bring out false and real selfishness in order to become unselfish without sacrificing personal fulfillment. The lower self with its lower aims must often be sacrificed, but is it really a sacrifice? No, it only seems so. What then emerges is real fulfillment. Your outer ego self is no longer in contradiction with your Godself. But this state comes only after you have learned to let go of the mask of false service and to expose the shortsighted selfishness of the lower, little self. Then you learn healthy selfishness, and from there you come into true selflessness that is not at all a contradiction to it.

When people follow spiritual teachings that emphasize service too soon, the danger exists that they will use these to escape from their inwardly residing selfishness. Thus they will cultivate a martyrdom service that is not wholesome for the soul. When the personality refuses to become truly autonomous, independent, and self-responsible, he will not want to meet his hidden selfishness. Therefore, his service will also be distorted.

In this light, you will comprehend the movement and dynamics of your own pathwork on an overall basis. And because it is a recurrent theme in thought-forms and symbolic spiritual expressions, perhaps I can use a figure you have used in many other respects: the three circles, the mandala-shaped design. In this figure the higher self is surrounded by the lower self which is surrounded by the mask self and the defenses. Individually you have dealt with this configuration again and again. The same applies to your community as a whole as well as to mankind as a whole.

Let us now look at your community. Those of you who are most involved in taking responsibility for the community as a whole, who have most deeply worked and exposed themselves and are thus beginning to reap tangible fruits of fulfillment represent the higher self of the group entity. You have traveled through these outer layers. You have learned more and more not to fear any part of your self, and you have come to accept all of you, thereby unifying what was once divided. You can identify more and more with your higher self since you are increasingly able to differentiate between it and the wishful thinking of the mask self that only hides the distortion and the untruth of the lower self. Thereby you come to the true voice of your higher self, which you can increasingly trust. Your community as a whole has come to this point, and I daresay you cannot miss feeling it. The evidence is in the increase in the numbers of new pathwork members; in the nature of these newer people who are more ready to understand and follow; in the deeper feelings of genuine love and joy among all of you; in the increased removing of blocks and obstructions, resolving of problems and conflicts so that fulfillment occurs on all levels for ever more of you. This fact can no longer be ascribed to coincidence but is clearly perceived as the natural expression of your development.

So, a good number of the inner nucleus function as the higher self of the community. This does not mean that you are perfect, of course not. But you are sufficiently capable of establishing the channel to your higher self. You are increasingly capable of totally committing yourself to the will of God and to perceive the importance of the Christ consciousness that sweeps your earth planet and to serve this cause. As such, you protect yourself in an incredibly efficient way against the onslaught of the countermovement. You immunize yourself against the countermovement from within your own lower self and therefore from without, against the lower self of the planet.

Then there are all those others working diligently on the path, still struggling, who are in the phase of owning up to the lower self, laboriously getting to know it by penetrating the concealments of the mask self. In this struggle, the temptation to hide, as well as the habit to do so, are strong factors. So are guilt and the fear of exposing the truth. And the illusion of this fear can only gradually be eliminated by testing it out until sufficient trust in the process evolves. There are those of you who at first cannot find the channel to your higher self and thus do not even want the channel to your higher self. You fear it, you do not trust it but trust more in the old, destructive habitual defenses.

Then of course there must always be those who are still strongly identified with their mask self. They have the most difficult time, and they seek reasons to discredit the process, to judge it. But this does not render them happier -- on the contrary. Their stake in the non-growing state is strong. Their fear of growing is equally strong so that they do not want to find out how unjustified this fear is. These are not necessarily friends new to the path, for it is not always a matter of time. These friends have to recognize that they identify with their mask self and must begin to travel through these layers.

The purpose of my saying this here is that you should experience yourself where you are and know it. As you have learned to take responsibility for your lower self and overcame the shame to admit it, so must you now learn to take responsibility for and not be ashamed of your higher self and to admit where you have indeed already arrived. Then you can give yourself even more fully to it. Then you can fully commit yourself to be a part of the great movement and feel the privilege, the

honor, the beauty, and the excitement of it. To give service to a greater cause will cleanse the residual little selfishnesses that make you fearful. You believe you cannot give all of yourself to a greater cause because you fear to do so. But I say to you once again, it is the other way around. You are afraid because you still cling to the little selfishness here or there. Consciously giving yourself to a greater cause and movement that sweeps all of the planet is in itself a cleansing process.

The new values of the new consciousness are precisely that. We will discuss further the new values in the lectures to come. We shall share these new and oldest truths. What I just said here is one of the most important aspects of the difference between the old and the new value systems. I say new though it has always existed in isolated highly developed individuals who have incarnated for a specific task. The great difference at this time is that the planet earth is growing up as a whole and is coming into its own divine consciousness.

The first thing for all of you in this respect must be a very conscious understanding that much more must be involved in your life than the immediate little personality. And you must also understand that this must lead to happiness, while at the same time happiness is its prerequisite. And that there is no division. To follow the will of God cannot deprive you, so that in years to come you will become more proficient in trusting total surrender to the God within, every day of your life, in every issue, in every venture, in every decision you undertake, even in the opinions you choose to adopt. In the new consciousness you will not make decisions with your head, superficially, wanting the immediate desire to be fulfilled. The new approach of the new consciousness makes decisions in an entirely new way. It realizes that the outer self does not know, is not trustworthy, is full of subjective and colored distortions and prejudices. The new consciousness always consults the higher self and learns to wait quietly for the answer patiently. It is never opinionated. It accepts that it does not know yet. It keeps itself open for the influx. It has no stake in a certain answer. It makes room for an answer that may be anything, whether it will be that which is most desired or totally its contrary, but it trusts that what will come will be good. It has no fixed opinion, it empties itself. That is one of the approaches of the new value system that must and will and already begins to sweep the planet.

This clashes of course with the other, the old value system that functions merely from the surface; from the immediate little emotions; from the narrow view and the narrow perception; and from having a stake in not even wanting to widen the perception and consider other alternatives and other possibilities. This old attitude is bound to clash with the new. It clashes within you, and it clashes in your environment between those who represent these two kinds of consciousness and approaches. That is indeed the clash of factions on this earth planet. But it will become more and more clear where you belong. It does not suffice to say, "I belong into the new" while you continue acting upon the old ways of functioning. You can say anything, but your actions, your approach to your inner and outer decisions are the final reality that proves in which camp you belong.

More and more of you have already made this commitment and are already taken up by the tremendous surge of this new golden light that sweeps the earth and that is unbearable only for those who refuse this light. They are the ones who perceive only the negative manifestation of the countermovement and are totally blind to the light itself. When the light comes near them, they feel strong discomfort and they misinterpret it. It is of the greatest joy for those who want it, for those who give themselves to it, for those who fight for it and serve it. This is my message for this time.

We shall continue all future lectures from this wider vision: how you as an individual fit into the scheme of the whole, how can you become happy only when you are part of this force that fights for the growing up and the purification of the planet to reach its own divinity. Your purification work on the path begins to acclimatize you to the joy and the light of what is to come. But you must now also begin to specifically aim for this, to meditate for it, to want it.

I have given you truly what you need in this first lecture of the year. It will be your map that I always give at the beginning of a new working season. Be blessed, my very dearest ones. You must and will increasingly feel how guided and protected you are, how important your venture is, what a privilege it is to be involved with it and give your all to it. For this is not only important for the little outer life. It is important in terms of evolution. Be blessed, my dearest ones.

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